★ MURDER AT THE DEADWOOD CANTINA ★

Deadwood Townsfolk

Dancer, Card player, Patron or Traveler — one of the colorful crowd at the tournament party.

How to Play It

Mingle, gossip and stir the pot! Pick a Western name, ask everybody nosy questions, and pass along any juicy rumors you hear. Dancers: sell those dance tickets and sarsaparillas!

For any extra role: pick 3 to use

1. Mitch Maverick! Congratulations on the big win — a businessman beat the poker greats? How'd you do it?
2. Harry, should we be worried about this cantina closin' its doors?
3. Sheriff Sam, got any leads on who robbed the bank earlier this week?
4. Henrietta, that's a mighty fancy necklace. Where'd you get it?
5. Billie, just how bad are the cantina's finances, and who do you blame?
6. Jesse Wales, what brings you to town — and what happened to that hand?

Be Ready If Asked

"Why are you in town?" → Make up a story: passing through to the gold fields, here for the tournament, visiting kin...

"Did you see anything this week?" → "Didn't see the robbery myself, but I've heard plenty of talk. What have YOU heard?"

"Who do you suspect?" → "I've got my eye on a few folks. Buy me a sarsaparilla and I'll tell ya." (Share gossip; don't invent evidence.)

When to use these: After Harry's welcome, pick 3 lines, go find the person each one mentions (or anyone nearby) and work all three into conversation before the lights go out. Tell the host quietly when you're done. After the murder, follow your B envelope.

Conversation starters for the opening of the party • your character sheet always comes first

OBJECTIVES

Starting Objectives:

- Discreetly let Harry High-Stakes (the cantina owner) know that you know his secret. (That Harry is bribing Sheriff Sam.)
- Tell Henrietta High-Stakes (Harry's business partner) that her partner is up to no good!
- Ask Billie-The-Bartender (the cantina barmaid and bookkeeper) about the finances of the cantina.
- Find out from Clay Coldwell (a regular) why he is not paying any attention to Sally Starr (a cantina girl).
- Question Elizabeth Money (Minnie's aunt) on how she feels about Minnie consorting with other men in the cantina.
- Ask Sally Starr if Clay's accusations about her behavior are true (that Sally was only using Clay for his money).



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Cantina Patron B

As a resident of Deadwood, you are a frequent visitor and a patron of the cantina. Since the town itself is still much in its settlement phase, businesses and residents are just starting to make Deadwood their home. When the Deadwood Cantina was established a little over a year ago, you welcomed the business with open arms. In the past year, you have seen the business of the cantina go from good to great. The Deadwood Cantina has become one of the prime locations to socialize and do business in town.

Since the town of Deadwood is still a budding frontier town, at times one might find it boring as you have. With the Deadwood Poker Tournament in town, however, there has been an air of liveliness that is very refreshing with new faces and continuous action in the cantina.

As a resident, you visit the cantina nightly as does Clay Coldwell, another resident who also entered the poker tournament this week. While you spend most of your time at the cantina playing cards and sipping sarsaparilla, Clay Coldwell spends much of his time on the dance floor, often with Sally Starr (a cantina girl). However, this week, you have noticed that Clay and Sally are not together at all! You are unsure if this is due to Clay's part in the tournament or if Sally is intentionally avoiding Clay. One person you have noticed on the dance floor a lot is Minnie Money (a debutante) dancing with Mitch Maverick (a businessman). The two appear to be close and you are uncertain how Minnie's family (Montgomery and Elizabeth Money) feel about Minnie keeping company with the businessman.

Although the cantina's business appears to be doing great, you have heard rumors that the cantina may be close to foreclosure from the bank. Since the cantina is packed most nights until close, you are uncertain how the cantina could be in any financial trouble, but your sources seem to be reliable. Because of your time at the cantina, you have observed that Harry High-Stakes (the owner of the cantina) is very devoted to his cantina and that he would do anything to keep his cantina up and running.

Despite how well you thought you knew Harry, you were shocked the other day when you witnessed Harry secretly paying off Sheriff Sam (the sheriff). Although you do not know why Harry was handing money over to Sheriff Sam, judging by the secretive nature of the exchange, you are certain that the transaction could not have been for an honest purpose.

While you are not looking forward to the poker tournament ending and Deadwood returning to its slower-paced lifestyle, you are excited to attend the Deadwood Poker Tournament Party. With the grand prize of $100,000 being awarded, there is certain to be a lot of action at the cantina!



Acting and Dressing Your Part: As a resident of Deadwood, a small frontier town in the Wild West, you are a rough and rugged cowboy or cowgirl. To the party, you will want to wear your western best, which may consist of cowboy boots, a hat, a bandana, shoestring tie, spurs, fringe, chaps and any other accessory you desire. *For more ideas on how to dress and a glossary of wild western words and phrases to use at the party, please see the party tips at www.nightofmystery.com. Simply type in murderatthedeadwoodcantina.com and explore the Guest Info and Costuming sections.*

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